

History of English Literature - Important MCQs (Part 57)

Page 282 - T.S. Eliot and Poetic Drama

Q1. T.S. Eliot's 'The Waste Land' presented a disturbing vision of the state of:

- A. The ancient world
- B. The contemporary world
- C. The future world
- D. The Victorian world

Answer: B

Q2. 'The Waste Land' is written in:

- A. Blank verse
- B. Rhymed couplets
- C. Free verse
- D. Terza rima

Answer: C

Q3. Eliot's vision in 'The Waste Land' is described as a Jeremiah-like vision of human society that is:

- A. Confused, dirty, and barren in spirit
- B. Joyful and harmonious
- C. Deeply romantic and idealized
- D. Pastoral and peaceful

Answer: A

Q4. The imagery in 'The Waste Land' was deliberately unromantic and drawn from the shabby side of:

- A. Rural life
- B. City life
- C. Sea life
- D. Mountain life

Answer: B

Q5. What was the purpose of the deliberate ugliness in 'The Waste Land'?

- A. To mock the poor
- B. To shock readers into seeing their 'waste land' as it was

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- C. To entertain children
- D. To imitate French poetry

Answer: B

Q6. Eliot's theory of verse-making in poetic drama was that poetry should conform to the rhythms of:

- A. Natural speech
- B. Classical Latin
- C. Shakespearean blank verse
- D. Chanting monks

Answer: A

Q7. Which two plays by T.S. Eliot conform to his theory of verse-making more closely than his earlier plays?

- A. Murder in the Cathedral and The Family Reunion
- B. The Cocktail Party and The Confidential Clerk
- C. The Cocktail Party and Murder in the Cathedral
- D. The Family Reunion and The Confidential Clerk

Answer: B

Q8. Eliot's development into a religious poet culminated in the sequence of poems collected as:

- A. The Waste Land
- B. Ash Wednesday
- C. Four Quartets
- D. Prufrock

Answer: C

Q9. Under the sway of T.S. Eliot's authority, poets grew timid of poetry marked by:

- A. Obscurity and gloom
- B. Intellectualism
- C. Verbal richness and buoyancy of spirit
- D. Free verse

Answer: C

Q10. It became the fashion to speak Shakespeare on stage in a manner which made it seem that poetry was

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intended to be:

- A. Shouted loudly
- B. Kept as a guilty secret from the audiences
- C. Sung like a musical
- D. Translated into prose

Answer: B

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Page 283 - Playwrights and Poets of the 1930s

Q1. The illusion that audiences do not like poetry on stage was dispelled by Christopher Fry's play:

- A. The Boy With a Cart
- B. A Sleep of Prisoners
- C. The Lady's Not For Burning
- D. The Dark is Light Enough

Answer: C

Q2. 'The Lady's Not For Burning' is the strange love story of a vagabond and a reputed:

- A. Princess
- B. Saint
- C. Witch
- D. Ghost

Answer: C

Q3. Christopher Fry's first published play, showing the influence of Eliot, was:

- A. The Lady's Not For Burning
- B. The Boy With a Cart
- C. A Sleep of Prisoners
- D. The Dark is Light Enough

Answer: B

Q4. In the 1930s, W.H. Auden and Christopher Isherwood collaboratively wrote which plays?

- A. The Dog Beneath the Skin, The Ascent of F. 6, and On the Frontier
- B. Trial of a Judge and A Sleep of Prisoners
- C. The Confidential Clerk and The Cocktail Party
- D. The Ascent of F. 6 and The Boy With a Cart

Answer: A

Q5. Who wrote the play 'Trial of a Judge'?

- A. W.H. Auden
- B. Christopher Isherwood

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C. Stephen Spender

D. C. Day Lewis

Answer: C

Q6. W.H. Auden succeeded which poet in the Professorship of Poetry at Oxford?

A. T.S. Eliot

B. C. Day Lewis

C. Louis MacNeice

D. Stephen Spender

Answer: B

Q7. Louis MacNeice wrote a number of interesting plays in later years for:

A. The West End theatre

B. Broadcasting

C. Silent films

D. Amateur companies

Answer: B

Q8. The outburst of poetry which was remarkable during the first World War was:

A. Repeated with greater intensity during the second World War

B. Not repeated during the second World War

C. Banned during the second World War

D. Focused on romantic love

Answer: B

Q9. The second World War was entered upon in 1939 with no popular fervour or:

A. Military strategy

B. Economic backing

C. Heroic idealism

D. Dogged determination

Answer: C

Q10. Poetry written during the darker stages of the second World War was for the most part:

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- A. Highly popular and accessible
- B. Beyond the understanding of the common reader
- C. Exclusively about nature
- D. Romantic sonnets

Answer: B

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Page 284 - Dylan Thomas and the Sitwells

Q1. Which poet began in the 1930s and reached a larger audience mainly through his success as a radio broadcaster?

- A. Stephen Spender
- B. Dylan Thomas
- C. W.H. Auden
- D. C. Day Lewis

Answer: B

Q2. Dylan Thomas received much posthumous acclaim for which poetical radio fantasy?

- A. Under Milk Wood
- B. The Dog Beneath the Skin
- C. The Ascent of F. 6
- D. Trial of a Judge

Answer: A

Q3. The Sitwell family were at first derided as:

- A. Too serious and gloomy
- B. Impudent and frivolous
- C. Uneducated and crude
- D. Overly traditional

Answer: B

Q4. The early poetry of Edith Sitwell seemed often artificial and toy-like due to her desire to:

- A. Mock Shakespeare
- B. Write for children
- C. Experiment and enlarge the technical range of verse
- D. Reject all poetic traditions

Answer: C

Q5. With the coming of war in 1939, Edith Sitwell's work received a strong impetus toward:

- A. Lighter comedy

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- B. More serious tendencies
- C. Prose fiction
- D. Political pamphlets

Answer: B

Q6. The text suggests Edith Sitwell must be considered on the level of the greatest:

- A. English women poets
- B. Playwrights
- C. Essayists
- D. Novelists

Answer: A

Q7. Who is mentioned as a woman poet that wrote a few perfect short poems but produced nothing comparable with Sitwell's more substantial works?

- A. Elizabeth Barrett Browning
- B. Emily Bronte
- C. Virginia Woolf
- D. Sylvia Plath

Answer: B

Q8. Osbert Sitwell surpassed his varied works as a poet and novelist with a remarkable five-volume autobiography titled:

- A. Left Hand, Right Hand
- B. The Sitwell Story
- C. Left and Right
- D. The Age of Sitwell

Answer: A

Q9. Sacheverell Sitwell devoted himself mainly to writings on:

- A. Politics
- B. Science
- C. Art
- D. Economics

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Answer: C

Q10. W.B. Yeats began as a late-Victorian romantic poet and ended as a twentieth-century:

- A. Satirist
- B. Metaphysical poet
- C. Prose novelist
- D. War poet

Answer: B

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Page 285 - Yeats, de la Mare, and the Novel

Q1. W.B. Yeats' progress can be assessed by comparing the simple 'Lake Isle of Innisfree' with the profound:

- A. The Waste Land
- B. Byzantium
- C. Ash Wednesday
- D. The Dark is Light Enough

Answer: B

Q2. Walter de la Mare was comparatively little affected by:

- A. The new trends in experimental poetry
- B. The Victorian romanticism
- C. The death of his friends
- D. The economic crisis

Answer: A

Q3. Walter de la Mare wrote many delightful poems for children in volumes such as:

- A. Left Hand, Right Hand
- B. Peacock Pie
- C. Under Milk Wood
- D. Four Quartets

Answer: B

Q4. Like all first-class writings intended for young people, de la Mare's children's poems:

- A. Lack any substance
- B. Have more than childish substance and older people find wisdom in them
- C. Are filled with political propaganda
- D. Are extremely obscure

Answer: B

Q5. De la Mare always makes his poems suggest depths of meaning beyond what the words actually say, writing with an appearance of such:

- A. Complex difficulty

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- B. Simplicity and ease
- C. Harsh reality
- D. Bitter satire

Answer: B

Q6. De la Mare hints at mystery, magic, and the breathless uncanniness of:

- A. Silence
- B. Urban noise
- C. War
- D. Politics

Answer: A

Q7. Walter de la Mare also wrote novels, such as:

- A. Left Hand, Right Hand
- B. Memoirs of a Midget
- C. The Old Wives' Tale
- D. Tono-Bungay

Answer: B

Q8. Virginia Woolf took which novelist as a typical example of the older kind of novelists?

- A. Thomas Hardy
- B. Arnold Bennett
- C. H.G. Wells
- D. John Galsworthy

Answer: B

Q9. In which essay did Virginia Woolf criticize the older kind of novelists?

- A. Mr. Bennett and Mrs. Brown
- B. The Art of Fiction
- C. A Room of One's Own
- D. Modern Fiction

Answer: A

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Q10. Virginia Woolf aimed at something finer in her novels that would convey the:

- A. Economic struggles of the poor
- B. Details of Victorian commerce
- C. Essences of human life
- D. Horrors of modern war

Answer: C

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Page 286 - Virginia Woolf and Bloomsbury

Q1. Virginia Woolf (Virginia Stephen) had been born into a literary household where her father was:

- A. Leonard Woolf
- B. Sir Leslie Stephen
- C. Lytton Strachey
- D. Arnold Bennett

Answer: B

Q2. When she married Leonard Woolf, Virginia became a principal figure among the group known as the:

- A. Bloomsbury Set
- B. Pre-Raphaelite Brotherhood
- C. Rhymers' Club
- D. Fabian Society

Answer: A

Q3. The Bloomsbury Set lived in what the text describes as very largely a:

- A. Bustling political arena
- B. Secular monastic circle
- C. Working-class commune
- D. Bohemian slum

Answer: B

Q4. According to the text, human life in the main is rough and coarse; to ignore that it is so deludes us into a:

- A. Pessimistic view
- B. Falsely delicate view of the world and its people
- C. Brutal realism
- D. Spiritual awakening

Answer: B

Q5. Virginia Woolf created a fictional world which was not a reflection of the actual world, but only a world made in the image of:

- A. Political ideals

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- B. Historical events
- C. Her own exquisite sensibilities
- D. Traditional romantic plots

Answer: C

Q6. The text argues that whereas Arnold Bennett creates characters outside himself, all Virginia Woolf's characters are:

- A. Historical figures
- B. Aspects of herself
- C. Ghostly apparitions
- D. Symbolic allegories

Answer: B

Q7. The author of the text asserts that Virginia Woolf was a great writer, but not a great:

- A. Poet
- B. Essayist
- C. Novelist
- D. Thinker

Answer: C

Q8. According to the text, what could Virginia Woolf not do?

- A. Put her self-characters into interesting situations
- B. Write in beautiful prose
- C. Tell a story
- D. Analyze human psychology

Answer: C

Q9. The modern belief that a story is unnecessary in a novel is described by the text as the outcome of a general decline in:

- A. Vocabulary
- B. Inventive power
- C. Political interest
- D. Reading skills

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Answer: B

Q10. If Virginia Woolf had lived in the sixteenth century, the text suggests she would have written:

- A. Plays
- B. Poetry
- C. Epics
- D. Sermons

Answer: B